Palouse Alliance for Heathy Individuals, Families and Communities

Mission: The Palouse Alliance for Healthy Individuals, Families and Communities is committed to the development and promotion of community health and trust through community initiative and participation, interagency cooperation and collaboration, and the sharing of information, resources and funding.

Vision: The health of the Palouse area community encompasses the physical, emotional, mental and spiritual aspects of each individual, family and community. The Alliance creates an environment where community learning and gathering is nurtured across all community segments. Our activities have diverse formats and include teachers and learners of all ages. In all of our activities, we integrate community strengths, interests, needs and initiatives.

Values

All dimensions of diversity
A spirit of service and participation among all community members
Collaboration to achieve mutual goals
Technological sophistication that is accessible and people focused
The pursuit of health and well-being as defined by individuals, families and communities
Mutual respect for individuals, families and communities
The prudent use of funds and resources

1984 ***Whitman County Health Coalition*** formed by group including the Whitman County Health Department and the Mental Health Center, Council on Aging & Human Services, Home Health & Hospice of the Palouse, Palouse Industries, and the county's two hospitals. The Health Department provided funding for a half-time position, office space, and supervision (Fran Martin), partners provided additional funding for staffing. One of the first activities was to provide health screenings and information at community events including the Southeastern Washington Fair, held outside Colfax. Deanna Rouch was the first Director.

1992 ***Whitman County Human Resource Providers*** group formed.

1993 ***Whitman County Alliance for Health and Human Services*** ("The Alliance") formed. The Alliance produced a monthly newsletter.

1994 Rural Health Systems Development Project grant received. This funding allowed the Alliance to identify strengths, weaknesses and gaps in Whitman County services; hire a coordinator; draft By-Laws; and participate in "Building Communities From The Inside Out" Conference presented by John L. McKnight in San Francisco.

1995 The Alliance held a strategic planning retreat. Pullman Memorial Hospital supported the Alliance by sponsoring Leeanne Kaiser to facilitate a program to develop a shared comprehensive vision for community health.

1996 The Alliance sponsored the Behavioral Risk Factor Survey of Whitman County Adults and the Whitman County Health Status Report in partnership with the Whitman County Health Department/Public Health Improvement Plan; began teaching the Fundamentals of Caregiving course.

1997 Public Health and Safety Network funded the Alliance's Community Asset Mapping project.

1998 Community Health Education Partnership grant received from the Washington State Department of Health to form the Whitman County Health Promotion Coalition (HPC). The HPC developed as a working arm of the Alliance to improve access to health education and information for the residents of Whitman County.

The principal objective was to implement topic-specific health education and health promotion activities. Statistics obtained from Whitman County's Behavioral Risk Factor Survey, Health Status Report, and Community Asset Mapping were used to establish task forces to focus on the five health risks for residents. These health risks consisted of cardiovascular disease, cancer, respiratory disease, drug and alcohol abuse, and domestic violence. The HPC received cash and in-kind support from Pullman Memorial Hospital, Whitman County Department of Public Health and WHMC and Medical Center. The HPC obtained a director; facilitated task forces; achieved incorporation; sponsored Body Walk; produced a Breast Cancer Resource Directory; presented at two state conferences; and attended the Health Care Forum's Healthier Communities, Best Practices Forum in Orlando.

1999 Substance Abuse and Family Violence Summit was held to develop an operational framework to align health and human service agencies toward common goals. Benefits identified by key stakeholders included:

- Minimizing confusion related to agency-specific roles and responsibilities; duplication of efforts; time spent in meetings; and unintentional competition.
- Maximizing efficient use of available resources; communication; strategic planning; data gathering; and information sharing. Those participating in the summit directed an interim board to operationalize its ideas. Subsequently, the ***Palouse Alliance for Healthy Individuals, Families and Communities*** (Palouse Alliance) was established. The Parent Resource Center became an affiliate member of the Alliance.

2000 Palouse Alliance Vision, Mission, Values, Goals, and By-Laws drafted.

2001 Received a Rural Health Foundation Grant to initiate Quick Start, a nursing assistant-certified (NA-C) training course and hire a program director. Additionally, the Alliance hired a coordinator to support their activities.

2002 Palouse Alliance approved for 501c (3) non-profit tax status.

2003 After two years of administering NA - C Program, completed negotiations with Spokane Community College to take over the recruitment, teaching and administrative duties.

2004 Reconfirmed our vision that the Palouse Alliance was created as a mechanism to decrease duplication, share information, take advantage of funding opportunities, "make better use of the health-related resources available in the community;" identified seniors as focal population

2005 Began partnership with WIN 211.

2006 Partnered with Gritman Adult Day Health on a HRSA Rural Health Care Outreach Grant to create Project ACCESS – a three-year project to increase access by rural seniors in Whitman and Latah Counties to social and health services

- Received grant three-year $375,000 grant with Palouse Alliance oversight
- Hired Grant Manager to facilitate both fiscal and program related functions
- ACCESS programs included: Gatekeeper Training, Volunteer Transportation, Caregiver Support Groups.

Parent Resource Center becomes Parent Resource Network for Families; discontinued fiscal affiliation with the Alliance; retained membership.

2009 Project ACCESS with Palouse Alliance oversight was granted a three year $540,000 HRSA Network Development Grant to create a Mental Health Network for professionals working with rural seniors in Whitman and Latah Counties.

- Project ACCESS/*Mental Health*
- Hired additional staff to develop a network of professionals, para-professionals and community members who work with seniors
- Network partners included Alzheimer's Association, Region II Area Agency on Aging, Council on Aging & Human Services, and the three area hospitals: Whitman, Pullman and Gritman

Contracted with Montana Banana to construct a functional website *AccessOnThePalouse.org* to identify network partners, advertise professional development opportunities around senior mental health, provide registration capabilities for Project ACCESS sponsored events.

Project ACCESS/*Mental Health* staff trained to be certified trainers in Mental Health First Aid Certification training programs; began offering MHFA certification training to area agency staff

Whitman County Commissioner becomes member of the Alliance

2010 Reconfirmed the Alliance as the oversight agency for Project ACCESS, serving as the Project's board.

2011 Project ACCESS changes acronym: Accommodate and Collaborate Community Education, Support and Services to widen scope community wide

Project ACCESS receives a one year HRSA Rural Network Planning Grant of $85,000 and Regence Foundation Grant of $35,000 to assess the feasibility of networking rural clinics and hospitals in Whitman and Latah counties and forming the Palouse Association of Rural Clinics.

Palouse Alliance receives Pullman Civic Trust/Inland NW Community Foundation Grant of $2,900 to support MHFA training for care-giving staff working with seniors in Whitman Co

Project ACCESS receives Moscow Giving Circle Grant of $2,900 for MHFA training in Latah Co.

Palouse Resource Network and Project ACCESS partner to house the Palouse Resource Guide on *AccessOnThePalouse.org*

2012 Project ACCESS presents recommendations for IT networking and shared case-management to Palouse area rural clinics.

Palouse Resource Network for Families re-establishes the Palouse Alliance as its fiscal agent and strategic partner to strengthen resources for families on the Palouse

2013 Alliance receives HRSA grant generated funds of $22,000 from Gritman Hospital to sustain Project ACCESS programs – MHFA and *AccessOnThePalouse.org*

Alliance transfers all management, operations and functional responsibilities of *AccessOnThePalouse.org* to the YMCA at WSU to return the focus of the website to the community-wide resource guide The *Palouse Resource Guide.*

2014 Alliance becomes a stakeholder in the Whitman County Community Needs Assessment initiative

2016 Palouse Resource Network celebrates success of the 20th Annual Family Fair

2017 Pullman Regional Hospital adopts and revitalizes the Palouse Resource Guide

2018 Alliance becomes the fiduciary agent for the Palouse STEAM Coalition

2019 Received $1500 Grant from Lewis-Clark Foundation to support annual Family Fair and Networking Breakfast

2020 Alliance partners with Washington State University English 402 class to assess communication and organizational strategies to advance our mission, resulting in a new logo

2021 Alliance offers its first drive through Family Fair, successfully distributing over 200 bags of community resource materials to Palouse area families

Received a $5,000 grant from the METER Foundation to partner with 3 Forks Bike and Sport to provide bike safety services, recreation and education in Whitman County

2022 Teamed with Families Together for People with Disabilities to offer the first Family Fair/Walk and Roll at the Pullman Playfields.

Received a $5,000 grant from the METER Foundation to partner with 3 Forks Bike and Sport to provide bike safety clinics, materials and education in rural Whitman County

2023 Received a $7,810 grant from the METER Foundation to partner with 3 Forks Bike and Sport to continue to provide bike safety clinics, bike rodeos, bike repairs and safety education throughout rural Whitman County

2025 Celebrated 40 years of community-based work with local health and human service providers at the Palouse Area Annual Networking Breakfast

Partnered with Pullman Chamber of Commerce to receive funding from the Nonprofit Association of Washington to support the cost of the 2026 Networking Breakfast and Family Fair

2026 Partnered with Washington State University student Computer Science two-semester Capstone course team to design, build and launch a event and resource sharing website during WSU's 2026 Spring and Fall semesters.

Received a $4160 grant from the Lewis Clark Valley Healthcare Foundation to fund an internship to administer the website beginning January 2027